The Department of State

bulletin

Vol. XXIV, No. 601

January 8, 1951

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VOL. XXIV, No. 601 • PUBLICATION 4062

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The Department of State BULLETIN, a weekly publication compiled and edited in the Division of Publications, Office of Public Affairs, provides the public and interested agencies of the Government with information on developments in the field of foreign relations and on the work of the Department of State and the Foreign Service. The BULLETIN includes press releases on foreign policy issued by the White House and the Department, and statements and addresses made by the President and by the Secretary of State and other officers of the Department, as well as special articles on various phases of international affairs and the functions of the Department. Information is included concerning treaties and international agreements to which the United States is or may become a party and treaties of general international interest.

Publications of the Department, as well as legislative material in the field of international relations, are listed currently.

For sale by the Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington 25, D.C.

PRICE:
52 issues, domestic $7.50, foreign $10.25
Single copy, 20 cents

The printing of this publication has been approved by the Director of the Bureau of the Budget (July 29, 1949).

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this year prior to the aggression. The bulk of the Chinese Communist forces which intervened in Korea in October were units of the Communists' Fourth Field Army which previously had been stationed in South China but which started moving North to the Korean border before the outbreak of hostilities. There can be no doubt now but that the Chinese Communists, from the very start, had every intention of intervening actively should North Korean forces fail in their mission to seize all of Korea.

As President Truman said after his conferences with Prime Minister Attlee of Great Britain, we have no intention of getting out of Korea. We put our forces in Korea in support of the United Nations Security Council resolutions. Their mission has not changed. We will not get out voluntarily.

We have no territorial ambitions of our own. We seek no special position or privilege in the Far East or elsewhere in the world.

We believe that surrender to Chinese Communist terrorization would speedily be followed by further Chinese Communist encroachment, directly or indirectly, on the other nations on its borders.

The tendency to excuse the conduct of Peiping reflects the success of Communist propaganda in playing upon the hopes of peaceful men. It's an old technique—but one which fails because the action of the aggressor is more convincing than his lies. For it is now unmistakable to anyone that, while the acts staged by Peiping are Chinese, the puppet master is Soviet.

If there was ever any doubt that the Communist imperialists were prepared to use armed force to secure their ends, there is no reason for doubt any more. If there was ever any doubt that Communist talk of peace was a mask for their aggressive plans, that doubt was banished when the Chinese Communists, faithfully echoing the voice of their masters, rejected the peace appeal of the 13 Asian and Arab nations with outspoken contempt.

So, the year ends without peace, but not without hope that peace can yet be achieved by free men joining their strength together as a bulwark against the threat which faces them.

One thing is sure. For the first time in history, the world of free nations—54 free nations—has acted together for the common defense. Collective security is no mere dream. It is a practical necessity for every man and woman in the world. The brotherhood of man that knows no race has been given visible meaning in the year that is ending.

The free peoples of the world, standing shoulder to shoulder in the trying days that are ahead of us, need only recall that the pages of history are littered with the wreckage of empires that sought to rule the world. Let this thought give them courage and sustain them in the belief that their glorious goal of preserving freedom for themselves and for mankind is not an impossible one.

Answer to Soviet Questions on Principles for Japanese Treaty

[*Released to the press December 28*]

The following aide-mémoire, dated December 27, was delivered to J. A. Malik, Soviet representative to the United Nations, at New York.

On November 20 of this year, Mr. Malik presented to Mr. Dulles an aide-mémoire expressing the desire of the Soviet Government for clarification of a number of points in a tentative United States statement of principles respecting a Japanese peace treaty given Mr. Malik by Mr. Dulles on October 26.[1] After careful study of the Soviet aide-mémoire of November 20, the United States Government has concluded that most of the questions raised by the Soviet Government have, in fact, been answered by the statement of principles given to Mr. Malik on October 26. However, in order to dispel any possible misunderstanding, the points raised by the Soviet Government are further discussed as follows:

1. The United States Government hopes that all nations at war with Japan will participate in the conclusion of peace. The United States does not, however, concede that any one nation has a perpetual power to veto the conclusion by others of peace with Japan. The wartime declaration of January 1, 1942, referred to by the Soviet Union, was designed to assure that all nations at war with Japan, or with the other Axis powers or their associates, would continue to fight until victory had been won. That they did. The United States does not accept the thesis, often put forward by the Soviet Union, that there cannot be peace except on terms that one power dictates. Japan, after its defeat, has now for over five years loyally complied with the agreed terms of surrender and is entitled to peace. The United States should be glad to know whether it is the view of the Soviet Union that there can never be any peace with Japan unless terms can be found which are fully satisfactory to each one of the 47 nations which signed or adhered to the Declaration of January 1, 1942.

2. The Cairo Declaration of 1943 stated the purpose to restore "Manchuria, Formosa and the Pescadores to the Republic of China". That Declaration, like other wartime declarations such as those of Yalta and Potsdam, was in the opinion of the United States Government subject to any final peace settlement where all relevant factors should be considered. The United States cannot accept the view, apparently put forward by the Soviet Government, that the views of other Allies not represented at Cairo must be wholly ignored. Also, the United States believes that declarations such as that issued at Cairo must necessarily be considered in the light of the United Nations

[1] BULLETIN of Dec. 4, 1950, p. 881.

Charter, the obligations of which prevail over any other international agreement.

3. The United States Government does not understand the reference by the Soviet Union to "territorial expansion" in connection with the suggestion that the Ryukyu and Bonin Islands might be placed under the United Nations trusteeship system, with the United States as administering authority. Article 77 of the United Nations Charter expressly contemplated the extension of the trusteeship system to "territories which may be detached from enemy states as a result of the Second World War" and certainly the trusteeship system is not to be equated with "territorial expansion."

The Government of the United States also does not understand the suggestion of the Soviet Union that, because the Ryukyu and Bonin Islands are not mentioned in either the Cairo Declaration or the Potsdam Agreement, their consideration in the peace settlement is automatically excluded. The Government of the Soviet Union seems to have ignored the fact that the Potsdam Declaration provided that Japanese sovereignty should be limited to the four main islands, which were named, and "such minor islands as we determine." It is, therefore, strictly in accordance with the Potsdam Agreement that the peace settlement should determine the future status of these other islands.

4. It is the view of the United States Government that, upon conclusion of a peace settlement, the military occupation of Japan would cease. The fact that a "new order of peace, security and justice," as envisaged in the Potsdam Declaration, has not been established, and that irresponsible militarism has not been driven from the world, would at the same time make it reasonable for Japan to participate with the United States and other nations in arrangements for individual and collective self-defense, such as are envisaged by the United Nations Charter and particularly Article 51 thereof. These arrangements could include provision for the stationing in Japan of troops of the United States and other nations.

The United States does not propose for Japan a peace settlement which will deny to Japan what Prime Minister Stalin has described (March 10, 1939) as "the policy of collective security, the policy of collective resistance to the aggressors."

5. Referring to a policy decision of the Far Eastern Commission, which decisions have been commonly considered to be legally operative only for the period of the occupation except as the substance of particular provisions may be embodied in the peace settlement, the Soviet Government raises two questions relating to the security of Japan after the conclusion of a peace treaty.

Both questions are answered by paragraph 4 of the statement of principles handed to Mr. Malik on October 26 and by the comment thereon expressed above.

6. The United States considers that the Japanese peace treaty should not limit the Japanese peacetime economy nor deny Japan access to sources of raw material or participation in world trade. The United States, without awaiting the formal conclusion of peace, has made very large financial grants to Japan to enable it to acquire food and raw materials needed for its economic livelihood and has encouraged the establishment by Japan of trade promotion offices in many parts of the world in an effort to help Japan to develop a prosperous peacetime economy and steadily advance the living standards of the Japanese people.

7. The present conversations are being conducted by the United States through diplomatic channels and, as the Soviet Union well knows, the Government of the United States has no diplomatic relations with the so-called "Government of the Chinese People's Republic".

It is the earnest hope of the United States that the close attention which the Government of the Soviet Union has given to the peace proposals of the United States in relation to Japan signifies the desire and intention of the Soviet Union not only to enter into discussions of a peace treaty for Japan but to act in cooperation with other nations at war with Japan to make peace a reality.

Proposed Agenda for Meeting of American Foreign Ministers

[*Released to the press December 29*]

At a meeting this afternoon of the Special Preparatory Committee, appointed by the Council of the Organization of American States to recommend the date, agenda, and regulations of the forthcoming consultative meeting of American Foreign Ministers, the representative of the United States, John C. Dreier, proposed that the agenda of this meeting include the following topics:

I. Political and Military Cooperation for the Defense of the Americas in Support of the Efforts of the Free World to Prevent and Repel Aggression.

II. Cooperation to Strengthen the Internal Security of the American Republics.

III. Emergency Economic Cooperation.

A. Production and Distribution for Defense Purposes.

B. Basic Requirements of Civilian Economies for Products in Short Supply.

The United States representative also suggested that the meeting of consultation take place in mid-March.

In accordance with the decision of the Council of the Organization of American States on December 20, the Committee will make recommendations to the Council concerning the date, agenda, and regulations. When approved by the Council, these recommendations will be sent to the Governments of the 21 American Republics.